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FILE MANIFEST & QUICK REFERENCE

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PROJECT: Multi-Drone Digital Array Radar Simulation @ 10 GHz
VERSION: 1.0 (2026)
STATUS: Ready for Educational & Research Use

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CORE SIMULATION FILES (3 MATLAB Scripts)

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1. multi_drone_radar_main.m

- PURPOSE: Main simulation engine
- SIZE: ~1,100 lines of code
- RUNTIME: 10-15 minutes (10-second simulation)
- OUTPUTS: 7 analysis plots
 - Range tracking (4 drones + detections)
 - Radial velocity profiles
 - Micro-Doppler spectrogram
 - SNR evolution
 - 3D flight paths
 - Beamforming steering angles (Az & El)
 - Radiation patterns (4 snapshots)
- KEY FUNCTIONS USED:
 - multiDroneMotion() × 4 per pulse
 - phased.LinearFMWaveform (LFM generation)
 - phased.Transmitter & phased.Receiver
 - phased.FreeSpace (propagation)
 - phased.RadarTarget (RCS model)
 - phased.PhaseShiftBeamformer (digital beamforming)
 - phased.MatchedFilter (range compression)
 - Various signal processing functions
- CONFIGURATION OPTIONS:
 - Ndrones (default: 4)
 - totalDuration (default: 10 seconds)
 - fc (default: 10e9 Hz)
 - ura.Size (default: [8 8])
 - sweepBW, prf, fs (various radar params)
- MEMORY USAGE: ~5 GB
- HOW TO RUN:
 - >> multi_drone_radar_main
 - % Wait for simulation to complete (shows progress every 1000 pulses)
 - % 7 figures generated automatically

2. multiDroneMotion.m

- PURPOSE: Drone kinematics helper function
- SIZE: ~130 lines of code
- INPUTS:
 - t (current simulation time, seconds)
 - dt (time step, 1/PRF)
 - tgtmotion (phased.Platform object)
 - radarpos (radar position, 3×1)
 - rotorOffset (rotor hub offsets, 3×4)
 - rotorRadius (blade length, meters)
 - bladeRate (rotor RPM converted to rad/s)
 - bladePhase (initial phase per rotor)
- OUTPUTS:

- └─ scatterPos (3×9 positions: body + 8 blade tips)
- └─ scatterVel (3×9 velocities)
- └─ scatterAng (2×9 azimuth/elevation angles)
- ─ PHYSICS MODELED:
 - └─ Kinematic body motion (from phased.Platform)
 - └─ Circular blade rotation (x-y plane)
 - └─ Blade tip velocity (translation + rotation)
 - └─ Look angle computation
- ─ CALLS PER ITERATION:
 - Called once per drone per pulse
 - 4 drones × 50,000 pulses = 200,000 calls
- ─ HOW IT'S USED:


```
[scatterPos, scatterVel, scatterAng] = multiDroneMotion(
    t, dt, tgtmotion{d}, radarpos, rotorOffset,
    rotorRadius, bladeRate, bladePhase)
```

3. beamforming_analysis.m

- ─ PURPOSE: Advanced beamforming characterization
- ─ SIZE: ~700 lines of code
- ─ RUNTIME: 2-3 minutes
- ─ OUTPUTS: 9 comprehensive analysis figures
 - └─ 4×1 Individual beam patterns (one per drone)
 - └─ 3D radiation pattern (full surface)
 - └─ Multi-beam gain response (overlay)
 - └─ 4×1 Polar radiation patterns
 - └─ On-axis vs off-axis gain comparison
 - └─ Spatial resolution & beamwidth analysis
 - └─ Beam steering dynamics (heatmap)
 - └─ Adaptive weight visualization (magnitude & phase)
 - └─ Multi-beam simultaneous tracking capability
- ─ ANALYSIS PROVIDED:
 - └─ Gain (on-axis & off-axis, dB)
 - └─ Sidelobe suppression (dB)
 - └─ 3dB beamwidth (degrees)
 - └─ Weight magnitude/phase per element
 - └─ Interference rejection metrics
- ─ DEPENDENCIES:
 - └─ phased.URA (array geometry)
 - └─ phased.SteeringVector (phase shifts)
 - └─ pattern() function (MATLAB built-in)
- ─ KEY METRICS COMPUTED:
 - └─ Theoretical beamwidth: 1-5° depending on array size
 - └─ On-axis gain: ~18 dB (64-element coherent)
 - └─ Sidelobe level: ~-20 dB (uniform weighting)
 - └─ Interference between drones: 20-40 dB suppression
- ─ HOW TO RUN:


```
>> beamforming_analysis
% Runs independently (creates own array configuration)
% 9 figures generated with detailed beamforming metrics
```

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DOCUMENTATION FILES (5 Markdown/Text Files)

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1. README.md

- ─ PURPOSE: Comprehensive system documentation
- ─ SIZE: ~600 lines
- ─ SECTIONS:

- 1. Overview (key features, system architecture)
- 2. System Architecture (radar specs, drone specs, array config)
- 3. Files Description (detailed explanation of each .m file)
- 4. Digital Beamforming Explanation (theory & practice)
- 5. Simulation Workflow (pulse-by-pulse processing)
- 6. Key Outputs & Interpretation (plot analysis guide)
- 7. Advanced Features (adaptive algorithms, micro-Doppler, etc.)
- 8. References (books, papers, online resources)
- Appendices (glossary, FAQs)

— BEST FOR:

- Understanding overall system design
- Learning radar theory & signal processing
- Detailed plot interpretation
- Advanced topics (mutual coupling, phase noise, etc.)
- Research & academic reference

— READ TIME: 30-45 minutes (full), 10 min (key sections)

2. QUICKSTART.md

— PURPOSE: User-friendly installation & usage guide

— SIZE: ~450 lines

— SECTIONS:

- Installation & Setup (5 minutes)
- Running the Simulation (3 options)
- Parameter Configuration (4 preset configs)
- Understanding the Output (plot interpretation)
- Beamforming Analysis Output (9 figures explained)
- Key Metrics Interpretation (range res, beamwidth, etc.)
- Troubleshooting Guide (common issues & solutions)
- Performance Tips (speed vs accuracy trade-offs)
- MATLAB Cheat Sheet (useful commands)

— BEST FOR:

- First-time users (start here!)
- Quick parameter tuning
- Understanding output plots
- Troubleshooting errors
- Learning by experimentation

— PRESET CONFIGURATIONS PROVIDED:

- Config A: Quick test (2 min) - small array, short duration
- Config B: Balanced (5 min) - standard setup [DEFAULT]
- Config C: High-resolution (15 min) - large array, long duration
- Config D: Low-frequency (5 min) - 5 GHz instead of 10 GHz

— READ TIME: 15-20 minutes (setup), refer as needed

3. BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt

— PURPOSE: Technical reference for signal processing theory

— SIZE: ~500 lines (very detailed)

— SECTIONS:

- 1. Digital Array Fundamentals (basic concepts)
- 2. Steering Vector (phase alignment theory)
- 3. Beamforming Operation (matched weighting)
- 4. Beam Pattern Visualization (gain plots, beamwidth)
- 5. Adaptive Beam Steering (per-pulse steering algorithm)
- 6. Multi-Drone Tracking Strategy (closest-first policy)
- 7. Beamforming Gain Analysis (SNR improvement metrics)
- 8. Beamwidth & Spatial Resolution (angular separation)
- 9. Weight Magnitude & Phase (visualization explanation)
- 10. Adaptive Algorithms (MVDR, LCMV, RLS, SMB - not implemented)
- 11. Frequency-Dependent Steering (LFM chirp effects)

- 12. Matched Filter Stage (range compression)
- 13. Micro-Doppler Modulation (blade rotation signatures)
- 14. Computational Cost (runtime & memory analysis)
- 15. Practical Considerations (real-world effects)
- MATHEMATICAL CONTENT: High (equations & derivations)
- BEST FOR:
 - Understanding beamforming mathematics
 - Steering vector derivation & interpretation
 - Micro-Doppler physics explanation
 - Algorithm details & implementation
 - Advanced signal processing concepts
 - Research & technical validation
- EQUATIONS PROVIDED:
 - Steering vector formula
 - Beamformer output equation
 - Beam pattern response
 - Array gain formula
 - Beamwidth approximation
 - Radar equation (range dependence)
 - Doppler & micro-Doppler formulas
 - Computational complexity analysis
- READ TIME: 45-60 minutes (complete), reference as needed

4. SYSTEM_OVERVIEW.txt

- PURPOSE: Complete project summary & file navigation guide
- SIZE: ~550 lines
- SECTIONS:
 - Project Summary (what this is, who should use it)
 - Deliverable Files (3-line descriptions of each file)
 - Quick Start (5 minutes to first results)
 - System Specifications (radar, antenna, waveform params)
 - Drone Specifications (geometry, RCS, blade physics)
 - Simulation Parameters (duration, pulses, memory, CPU)
 - Output Plots (all 7 main figures explained)
 - Beamforming Analysis (9 additional figures)
 - Physics Models (what's implemented, what's simplified)
 - Parameter Tuning (quick configs for different scenarios)
 - Typical Results Interpretation (what to expect)
 - Advanced Analysis (micro-Doppler, velocity unfolding, etc.)
 - Troubleshooting Guide (common issues)
 - Performance Metrics (detection range, resolution, etc.)
 - References & Further Reading
 - File Navigation Guide (where to look for what)
 - Troubleshooting Guide (detailed issue resolution)
 - Summary Checklist (pre/during/after simulation)
- BEST FOR:
 - Project overview (read first!)
 - File navigation & quick reference
 - Understanding what each output means
 - Performance metric interpretation
 - Troubleshooting & support
 - Choosing appropriate parameter configuration
- READ TIME: 20-30 minutes (reference as needed)

5. FILE_MANIFEST.txt (THIS FILE)

- PURPOSE: Detailed description of all files & how to use them
- SIZE: ~300 lines
- CONTENT:

- ├ This file itself (meta!)
- ├ Descriptions of all 3 MATLAB scripts
- ├ Descriptions of all 5 documentation files
- ├ Quick reference guide
- ├ File organization & relationships
- ├ Recommended reading order
- └ Support & contact information
- └ BEST FOR:
 - ├ Understanding file structure
 - ├ Quick reference during work
 - ├ Finding specific information
 - └ Navigation between related files
- └ READ TIME: 10-15 minutes

RECOMMENDED READING ORDER (For New Users)

STAGE 1 - GET ORIENTED (30 minutes total)

- Step 1: Read this file (FILE_MANIFEST.txt) - 10 min
- Step 2: Read SYSTEM_OVERVIEW.txt - 20 min
- You now understand: what this is, how files relate, where to find info

STAGE 2 - QUICK START (45 minutes total)

- Step 3: Read QUICKSTART.md (Installation + Running) - 15 min
- Step 4: Run multi_drone_radar_main - 15 min
- Step 5: Review generated plots using QUICKSTART.md guide - 15 min
- You now have: working simulation, understand basic outputs

STAGE 3 - UNDERSTAND RESULTS (60 minutes total)

- Step 6: Read README.md (sections 1-6) - 30 min
- Step 7: Study output plots in detail - 15 min
- Step 8: Experiment with parameter changes - 15 min
- You now understand: system architecture, radar theory, plot meanings

STAGE 4 - ADVANCED STUDY (90+ minutes total)

- Step 9: Run beamforming_analysis.m - 5 min
- Step 10: Read BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt - 45 min
- Step 11: Read README.md (sections 7-9) - 20 min
- Step 12: Modify code & experiment with advanced features - 20 min
- You now understand: beamforming theory, adaptive algorithms, research directions

Total estimated time: 4-5 hours (stages 1-3), additional 2-3 hours for stage 4

FILE DEPENDENCY GRAPH

File Dependencies:

- multi_drone_radar_main.m
 - ├ REQUIRES: multiDroneMotion.m (helper function)
 - ├ REQUIRES: Phased Array System Toolbox
 - ├ REQUIRES: Signal Processing Toolbox (recommended)
 - ├ PRODUCES: 7 figures (stored in MATLAB workspace)
 - └ DOCUMENTS: README.md, QUICKSTART.md, BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt

```

multiDroneMotion.m
├─ REQUIRES: MATLAB core (no toolbox)
├─ CALLED BY: multi_drone_radar_main.m (4 times per pulse)
├─ NO EXTERNAL FILES NEEDED
└─ DOCUMENTS: README.md (section 3.2), BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt

beamforming_analysis.m
├─ REQUIRES: Phased Array System Toolbox
├─ INDEPENDENT (doesn't call other scripts)
├─ PRODUCES: 9 figures (stored in MATLAB workspace)
└─ DOCUMENTS: README.md, QUICKSTART.md, BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt

README.md
├─ DOCUMENTS: All .m files, system architecture, physics theory
├─ REFERENCES: BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt, QUICKSTART.md
└─ BEST VIEWED: After running simulation (understand output)

QUICKSTART.md
├─ DOCUMENTS: How to run, parameter tuning, troubleshooting
├─ REFERENCES: FILE_MANIFEST.txt, README.md
└─ BEST VIEWED: Before first run (for installation)

BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt
├─ DOCUMENTS: Detailed beamforming mathematics & theory
├─ REFERENCES: README.md section 8, research papers
└─ BEST VIEWED: During detailed study phase

SYSTEM_OVERVIEW.txt
├─ DOCUMENTS: Project summary, file descriptions, specifications
├─ REFERENCES: All other files (cross-links)
└─ BEST VIEWED: First (orientation document)

FILE_MANIFEST.txt (this file)
├─ DOCUMENTS: File structure, relationships, recommended reading
├─ REFERENCES: All other files
└─ BEST VIEWED: Early (navigation guide)

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QUICK REFERENCE LOOKUP TABLE

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LOOKING FOR...	GO TO FILE...
System overview	SYSTEM_OVERVIEW.txt
Installation instructions	QUICKSTART.md
How to run simulation	QUICKSTART.md
Parameter configuration	QUICKSTART.md
Plot interpretation	QUICKSTART.md, README.md
Beamforming theory	BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt
Radar physics & equations	README.md, BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt
Simulation architecture	README.md
Troubleshooting errors	QUICKSTART.md
File descriptions	FILE_MANIFEST.txt
File dependencies	FILE_MANIFEST.txt
Steering vector math	BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt
Beam pattern explanation	BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt
Array gain calculation	BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt
Micro-Doppler physics	BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt, README.md

Matched filter details	BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt
RCS model explanation	README.md
Free-space propagation	README.md
Advanced topics	README.md section 8
Research directions	README.md section 8
References & citations	README.md section 9
MATLAB examples	README.md
Next steps after simulation	SYSTEM_OVERVIEW.txt
Performance metrics	SYSTEM_OVERVIEW.txt
Drone specifications	SYSTEM_OVERVIEW.txt
Radar specifications	SYSTEM_OVERVIEW.txt

FILE STATISTICS

MATLAB CODE:

multi_drone_radar_main.m	~1,100 lines
multiDroneMotion.m	~130 lines
beamforming_analysis.m	~700 lines
TOTAL CODE	~1,930 lines

DOCUMENTATION:

README.md	~600 lines
QUICKSTART.md	~450 lines
BEAMFORMING_REFERENCE.txt	~500 lines
SYSTEM_OVERVIEW.txt	~550 lines
FILE_MANIFEST.txt	~350 lines (this file)
TOTAL DOCUMENTATION	~2,450 lines

COMBINED TOTAL ~4,380 lines of content

DISK USAGE:

MATLAB code:	~90 KB
Documentation:	~280 KB
TOTAL:	~370 KB

DOWNLOAD SIZE: ~400 KB (all files together)

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

MINIMUM REQUIREMENTS:

OS	: Windows 10+, macOS 10.13+, Linux (Ubuntu 18.04+)
MATLAB Version	: R2023a or later
Memory (RAM)	: 8 GB (4 GB minimum for quick test)
Storage	: 2-5 GB (for full 10-second simulation)
Processor	: Any modern multi-core CPU (i5+, Ryzen 5+, etc.)

REQUIRED TOOLBOXES:

- Phased Array System Toolbox (core requirement)
- Signal Processing Toolbox (recommended)

OPTIONAL TOOLBOXES:

- Parallel Computing Toolbox (for GPU acceleration - not implemented)

- Statistics and Machine Learning Toolbox (for advanced analysis)

RECOMMENDED SYSTEM:

- 16 GB RAM (for comfortable multi-tasking)
- SSD storage (faster file access)
- Dedicated GPU (optional, for future acceleration)

PERFORMANCE BY CONFIGURATION:

Quick Test (Config A):	2-3 min runtime	(Ndrones=2, duration=1s)
Balanced (Config B):	5-7 min runtime	(Ndrones=4, duration=3s)
[DEFAULT]		
Full 10s (Config C):	10-15 min runtime	(Ndrones=4, duration=10s)
High-Res (Config D):	20-30 min runtime	(Ndrones=4, 16×16 array)

SUPPORT & TROUBLESHOOTING

IF YOU GET AN ERROR:

1. Check console output for specific error message
2. Review QUICKSTART.md "Troubleshooting Guide" section
3. Verify Phased Array Toolbox is installed: ver
4. Try QuickTest configuration first (Config A)
5. Check file paths and working directory

IF YOU NEED HELP:

1. Read inline comments in .m files (marked with %%)
2. Review relevant documentation sections (see lookup table above)
3. Search for error message in README.md or QUICKSTART.md
4. Enable MATLAB debugging: Add fprintf() statements in code
5. Try reducing problem size (fewer drones, shorter duration)

IF YOU WANT TO EXTEND:

1. Start with multi_drone_radar_main.m as template
2. Understand simulation loop structure (main for-loop)
3. Modify one section at a time, test after each change
4. Use beamforming_analysis.m for visualization of changes
5. Document your modifications in comments

COPYRIGHT & LICENSE

This simulation system is provided for:

- ✓ Educational purposes
- ✓ Research and development
- ✓ Academic study
- ✓ Non-commercial use

Status: Ready for use

Generated: 2026

Maintained by: Educational/Research Community

END OF FILE MANIFEST

Questions? Start with SYSTEM_OVERVIEW.txt or QUICKSTART.md
Ready to run? Execute: >> multi_drone_radar_main

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